The AD2000 Movement as a Great Commission Catalyst
By Luis Bush

INTRODUCTION

My topic is *The AD2000 Movement as a Great Commission Catalyst.* My thesis is that the AD2000 Movement served as Great Commission Catalyst by remaining tightly focused on its stated purpose throughout its decadal existence.

By January of 1989, more than 2000 individual plans for global evangelism were identified, each focusing on the year 2000! One-third of these originated in Africa, Asia and Latin America, which until recently, were viewed as the major focus of missionary concern. The Church planted in those areas was now on the move, reaching out with the same gospel to reproduce itself throughout the whole world. The authors of the plans met in Singapore early in 1989 to exchange notes. Despite great diversity in the group there were four significant outcomes. First, people realized that the 2000 vision was something God had placed on the hearts of so many Christian leaders throughout the world. Second, there was duplication in many of the plans. Third, there needed to be a coalescing-type committee or group to facilitate cohesion of initiative and reduce duplication. Fourth, there was a united commitment to what was called *The Great Commission Manifesto*.

A few months later, Christian leaders from around the world embraced the spirit and words of the final paragraph under the eleventh affirmation of the Lausanne II Manila Manifesto. "The year 2000 has become a challenging milestone. We commit ourselves to evangelize the world during the last decade of this millennium" (Douglas 1990:37).

AD2000 was born—a servant catalyst—to encourage, network, inspire, research, and disseminate information about what the Holy Spirit is doing through the Church globally. The intention was to encourage cooperation among existing churches, movements and structures to work together towards this same vision (Bush 1993:1).

In what way did AD2000 serve a Great Commission catalyst? The term *catalyst* is defined in The American Heritage Dictionary of the English Language first within the semantic field of Chemistry, as a "…substance, usually used in small amounts relative to the reactants, that modifies and increases the rate of a reaction without being consumed in the process." In the more generic sense it is defined as: "One that precipitates a process or event" (American Heritage Dictionary 1997, 1998).

To what extent did AD2000 serve catalytically to *precipitate* and *increase the rate of reaction* of the Great Commission process to advance the Christian movement is the question this paper seeks to address? A number of Christian leaders were hopeful at the beginning of the decade such as Patrick Johnstone, author of *Operation World*, who observed, "I believe that God has given us the best opportunity in all history to gain a wide level of support among Christians committed to world evangelization in the AD2000 vision" (c.1992). At the end of the decade Patrick's assessment was as follows: "In retrospect we believe that we have had the privilege of being involved in the greatest focused global Great Commission movement in history" (Johnstone 2000).

This presentation seeks to reflect on the Great Commission catalytic impetus generated by AD2000. The stated purpose of AD2000 was to motivate and network men and women church leaders by inspiring them with the vision of reaching the unreached by the year 2000 through consultations, prayer efforts and communication materials (Bush 1993:1,44). It is the contention of the author that the continuous efforts by AD2000 leaders to implement the various parts of the AD2000 purpose that precipitated involvement in the Great Commission.

The catalytic nature of AD2000 on the Great Commission is viewed by considering the primary elements in this purpose statement which are as follows:

1. Motivating for the Great Commission
2. Networking for the Great Commission
3. Focusing on the unreached and the Great Commission
4. The year 2000 and the Great Commission
5. Consultations and the Great Commission
6. Prayer efforts and the Great Commission
7. Communication materials and the Great Commission

1. MOTIVATING FOR THE GREAT COMMISSION

The two key catalytic words contained in the AD2000 purpose were *motivate* and *network* (Bush 1993:44). Men and women were motivated by inspiring them with a compelling vision. Out of the many plans by denominations, mission agencies, global conferences, national movements and other Christian organizations the vision watchword became *A Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by the year 2000*.

AD2000 was a vision-driven movement. Thomas Wang, while serving as the International Director of the Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization (LCWE), observed the number of major denominations and mission groups with a plan for evangelization with the AD2000-time-target and wrote an article, posing the question:. *The Year 2000: Is God Trying to tell us Something?* (Wang 1987). Christian leaders with plans were motivated to share their own visions and listen to others. They came together at Singapore in early 1989.

The vision did not change or become diluted during the course of the decade. Those involved remained focused on the original vision. As a servant-catalyst, AD2000 involved Christian leaders by serving existing structures that shared the same vision. This common purpose multiplied and broadened implementation efforts. The resulting sum total was greater than each individual part. One example of this occurred with the call of Bill Bright. He called

for a meeting with the Campus Crusade for Christ (CCC) Directors of Affairs to present the AD2000 vision with the prospect of finding common ground that could mutually enhance the broader initiative of God in both AD2000 and CCC. The resulting cooperative relationship between the two entities enhanced AD2000 while boosting the New Life 2000 project being undertaken by CCC.

Christian leaders responded worldwide from large, medium and small organizations, ministries, churches, denominations and movements. Lay men and women became involved. There were formal and informal relationships established. Involvement included spiritual and operational aspects.

AD2000 was fueled by the distinct giftedness of the leaders and their organizations. As each mission leader considered aligning with the Movement, he or she faced the same question, both internally and from others. "Is there enough added value by involving myself and the ministry/organization I represent in the AD2000 process to merit the cost in terms of time, money, and risk of criticism?" As leaders plunged or waded into the Movement, we learned from and grew to respect one another.

2. NETWORKING FOR THE GREAT COMMISSION

The primary building block for the first half of the decade, enabling AD2000 to operate as a grassroots, bottom-up movement, was the functional network. These functioned on local, statewide, national, regional, and global levels. Communication took place during network and national consultations, through electronic mail, on the Internet, at annual status meetings, through track/network newsletters, and at GCOWE '95 and '97.

Through functional networks, and within the general purpose of AD2000, there was a global multiplier effect. Each of the tracks, by design, stood as a semi-autonomous unit, with respective chairpersons and coordinators responsible for the organization, personnel, style,

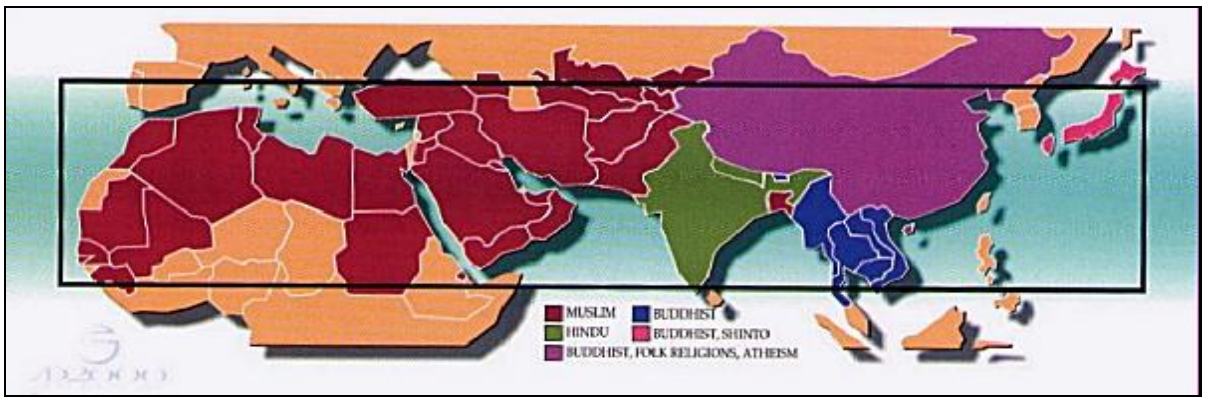
funding, and activities of their track. The specific track objectives were in support of the overall objectives of the Movement. The result reinforced the vision of the presentation of the gospel to every person in every nation and people group, and the establishment of an indigenous church planting movement in every country and people group by the year 2000. Annual meetings with track and task force leaders kept the loose structure from dissolving. Track leaders worked out among themselves the ways and means of helping each other, engaging in joint projects, eliminating unnecessary redundancy and synchronizing their activities. Each track sought ways to support and encourage other tracks.

3. FOCUSING ON THE UNREACHED AND THE GREAT COMMISSION

At the first meeting of the international board of AD2000 in July 1990, it became clear to all that if we were serious about providing a valid opportunity for every people to experience the love, truth and saving power of Jesus Christ, we could not ignore the reality that we must concentrate on the spiritually resistant region of the world (Minutes 1990:m.s.). They were referring to what has become widely known as *the 10/40 Window*.

The 10/40 Window

The priority, but not exclusive focus of AD2000 became *the 10/40 Window*, a term coined for the area of the world between ten degrees and forty degrees North latitude, stretching from



MAP 1

THE 10/40 WINDOW (Bush 1991:3)

northern Africa and southern Spain to Japan and the northern Philippines.

Critics argued that to focus on *the 10/40 Window* is to skew the biblical call to the whole world. "Too many expressions of reductionist thinking (over-simplifications of the complex task) have influenced the Evangelical missionary movement for the last fifty years. They include … a limited geographic focus…." (Taylor 1999).

There were compelling reasons for focusing on the 10/40 Window (Bush 1991:1*). The 10/40 Window* represented the place where most of the least-evangelized peoples and countries of the world lived. Ninety-seven percent of the people living in the fifty-five least evangelized countries in 1989 resided in *the 10/40 Window*. This was also where eighty-five percent of the poorest of the poor lived.

Joshua Project 2000

It was the conviction of participants at GCOWE '95 that a global effort was needed to focus attention and provide tools for implementing the vision for the church for every people by the year 2000 by developing a selected list of unreached peoples. Christian leaders came

together several months later for what was called *The Launch*. The Launch represented the initiation of the implementation phase of AD2000 for the second half of the decade following the vision-casting phase of the first half. In order to work together toward the vision two approaches were adopted, 1) national initiatives to the year 2000 that would prioritize pioneer church planting among the unreached and 2) Joshua Project 2000.

Joshua Project 2000 was a global cooperative strategy, focused on the least evangelized peoples of the world, that sought to engage every church, agency, denomination and Christian from every country in the world in an effort to implement the goal of *A church for every people and the gospel for every person by AD2000*. The goal of Joshua Project 2000 was to establish a pioneer church planting movement within every ethno-linguistic people[1] of over 10,000 individuals within every country of the world by December 31, 2000. "The Joshua Project . . . is the largest strategic mobilization of Christians in history to disciple the people of the world. Support and enthusiasm has come from across a wide spectrum of denominations agencies and countries. In the latter, the involvement has been predominantly non-Western..." (Johnstone 1998:107).

National Initiatives and the Unreached: A Case Study from Kenya

The GCOWE '97 African National Initiatives Consultation (ANI) Consultation produced a vision to build on the momentum and hold five to six key regional and national consultations

---

[1] Criteria for listing on the selected peoples of the Joshua Project 2000 list were as follows: ethno-linguistically distinct, country distinct, greater than 10,000 population in given country, less than two percent Evangelical and less than five percent Christian Adherents. Hundreds of churches, mission agencies, denominations and theological institutions from around the world have become involved.

throughout Africa by the end of 1998. Speaking on behalf of the Kenyan delegation, made up of more than eighty leaders, Stephen Kabachia said, "When the Kenya delegation was confronted by lists of unreached peoples in Kenya, they determined that never again would a Kenyan delegation attend a global consultation to be embarrassed by such lists." They called their plan: *Finish the Task 2000*. As a result of this plan a nation-wide consultation with five hundred leaders was held, all the unreached peoples identified were adopted by denominations, churches and seminaries, and prayer efforts and pioneer church planting efforts were initiated.

4. THE YEAR 2000 AND THE GREAT COMMISSION

The fall of the Berlin Wall in 1989 symbolized a dramatic turning point in human history. The break-up of the former Soviet Union, the movement of some nations toward democracy, the migration of hundreds of thousands of refugees across national borders, the intensification of tribalism and nationalism have altered the geo-political landscape. The dismantling of the old Soviet Empire under the centralized authoritarian regime resulted in a proliferation of nations open to new ideas. One of the consequences is that since 1990, the United Nations (UN) has grown twenty-eight percent in number of nations. It was as though God were shaking the nations, giving access to Christian messengers as had not happened in a hundred years. The contextual conditions surrounding the end of the second millennium have served to provide a suitable platform to launch a global Christian movement. In addition, the year 2000 became a giant magnet for all of mankind.

Secularist Sees a Decline of the Age of Unbelief in the 1990's

Early in the decade, Time magazine published a four-page essay entitled*: The Year 2000: Is it the end or just the beginning?* The author, Henry Grunwald, is a former U.S. ambassador to Austria, and Time's former editor-in-chief. Writing from a secular perspective, Grunwald summarizes his thesis in the introduction by saying, "People feel as if the hand of God were turning a page in human fate. We have a sense of things ending and others beginning" (Grunwald 1992:74). He makes three observations:

> First, of course, we are witnessing the end of communism. Second, we are witnessing the end of nationalism, as we have known it and beginning to look for new international arrangements; and third, we are witnessing the end, or at least the decline, of the age of unbelief and the beginning of what may be a new age of faith (Grunwald 1992:74).

This last point is the major point of his article. "Many people seem to want a faith that is rigorous or demanding, or else more personal... Throughout the Third World, Christian churches especially the Evangelicals are gaining more converts than ever before" (Grunwald 1992:76).

Futurists Predict Spiritual Awakening for the 1990's

Not only secularists, but futurists also predicted a spiritual awakening in the 1990's. In his best-selling book titled *Megatrends 2000*, John Naisbitt described the "unmistakable signs of a worldwide multi-denominational religious revival" (Naisbitt 1990). Upon observing the significance of this trend, he wrote a follow-up book titled *Religious Revival of the Third Millennium*.

> The bond we share today with the people of past millennial eras is the sense of living in a time of enormous change. .. When people are buffeted about by change, the

> need for spiritual belief intensifies. The "God is dead" philosophy of the past is being quickly replaced. With the millennium in sight, the powerful countertrend of the religious revival is repudiating blind faith in science and technology. Huge increases have been experienced in church membership, especially among Evangelical and Charismatic denominations. With the explosive growth continuing…(Rogers 1990).

Significance of the Year 2000 to Believers

Beginning in the late 1980's, thousands of Christian leaders and laymen anticipated a time of divine visitation. Many prayed for God's direction. Some planned. The editors of the Manila Manifesto, the expression of 3,000 Christian leaders representing 170 countries gathered at Lausanne II in mid-1989, posed the question . . .

> Now the year 2000 has become for many a challenging milestone. Can we commit ourselves to evangelize the world during the last decade of this millennium? There is nothing magical about the date, yet should we not do our best to reach this goal? Christ commands us to take the gospel to all people. The task is urgent. We are determined to obey Him with joy and hope (Douglas 1990:37).

The year 2000 instilled a sense of urgency. It spurred many on to decisive action. Many were impelled to ask: What can we do to seek to fulfill the mandate of Jesus, given to his follower's two millennia ago, to make disciples of all the nations and to preach the gospel to every creature so that there is a church for every people and the gospel is made available to every person?

5. PRAYER EFFORTS AND THE GREAT COMMISSION

Prayer was the major strategy of AD2000. It under-girded every planning meeting, every event, the launch of every initiative. The approach to the meetings followed a pattern. Divide the time equally between the challenges and reports of various AD2000 Christian leaders. Allow

time for response from other leaders to those challenges and reports. Initiate a time of seeking God about the things that were shared and discussed.

Prayer Triplets and the AD2000 Women's Network

By the time of GCOWE '95, women leaders in more than 150 countries had become involved in the AD2000 and Beyond Movement. Evelyn Christenson, author of bestseller, When Women Pray, wrote a prayer study guide for use by the AD2000 Women's Track. By 1995, it had been translated into twenty-three languages. Among the Women's Track goals for the year 2000 was to have prayer triplets functioning in 180 countries (GCOWE '95 Handbook 1995:125).

Praying Through the10/40 Window

Praying Through the Window I, a global prayer initiative in October 1993, focused on the countries located within the10/40 Window. *Praying Through the Window II*, in October 1995, focused prayer on the one-hundred Gateway Cities of the 10/40 Window. *Praying Through the Window III*, in October 1997, focused prayer on the 10/40 Window's 132 unreached people clusters, most of whom have never heard the gospel in their own language in a culturally sensitive way. *Praying Through the Window IV* in October 1999, focused once again on the countries of the 10/40 Window with prayer teams assigned to the 1,000 major towns.

Upon adding the total number of intercessors in the first three efforts along with about forty million, as recorded in the minutes of the last meeting of the 1999 Praying Through Window Steering Committee (chaired by Michael Little, President of CBN), the number exceeded 120 million (1999:228). Bev Pegues recorded and tabulated thousands of prayers

journeys and millions of home-based intercessors involved in the Praying Through the Window emphases.

New Approaches to Prayer Encouraged and Disputed

As was pointed out in a 1994 article in *Christianity Today*, the mass prayer movement has not taken place without controversy. The article describes spiritual warfare as "A highly controversial subject among Christians..." (Tapia 1994:80,85). Prayer-related expressions began to be used in the prayer track such as strategic-level spiritual warfare, spiritual mapping, and identificational repentance (Wagner 1996:8).

United Prayer Track leader Peter Wagner explained the reason for the emphasis on spiritual warfare.

> I believe that the major reason why more people haven't become believers through the centuries is that the "god of this age" has successfully blinded their minds (see 2 Cor. 4:3-4). Nevertheless, steady progress has been made and today Satan is backed up in what could possibly be seen as his last geographical fortress, the 10/40 Window (not denying, of course, that Satan is also much too malignantly active in virtually every other part of the world as well) (1996:7-8).

Wagner wrote a series of books over the course of the decade called the "Prayer Warrior" series in which he reported to the body of Christ some observations on the prayer movement worldwide and on the spiritual tools being used.

Prayer at GCOWE '95

One example of the significant role of prayer in relation to mobilizing Christian leaders was noted at GCOWE '95. It was highlighted by the schedule of the plenary sessions. Sprinkled throughout the minute-by-minute outline was "praying for the unreached peoples in twos and

threes," "Korean-style prayer for every country to have a national initiative focused on the unfinished task," "prayer and weeping for the cities," "prayer for mobilization," and so on. Prayer was not only planned but spontaneous as time was taken to pray whenever the Spirit led during the meetings. Two or more delegates with hands joined praying in the hallways was a common sight.

Intercessory prayer "covering" was also seen as key to progress. Over one hundred prayer intercessors paid their own way to Seoul to pray around the clock for GCOWE '95. The Sunday evening worship service was a highlight for many as the delegates were led in a "Concert of Prayer." Fifty children interceded throughout GCOWE '95. Vonette Bright, former Chairperson, Lausanne Prayer Committee said: "I have never experienced so much prayer in an international gathering of Christians before" (Hardgrove 1995).

6. COMMUNICATION MATERIALS AND THE GREAT COMMISSION

Great Commission efforts were catalyzed, not only through consultations and prayer efforts, but also through communications. Communications were generated both formally and informally as a vital part of the process of involving Christian leaders. For significant events, a few timely, quality press releases were produced and distributed. Reports were generated of what God was doing through national and network initiatives. There was a considerable spread of ownership and contributions.

Newsworthy reports of AD2000-related events, progress, and perspectives were distributed through electronic conferences, via e-mail and, upon approval by the national coordinator, later on the Internet. Due to the public nature of the Internet, however, on several occasions these Internet-published reports stirred up opposition by groups opposing Christian witness in their nations. This led to a discussion on appropriate and inappropriate terminology, which in turn led to a consultation on the appropriate language of mission.

The provision of low or no-cost electronic communication tools was seen as a specific provision by the Lord for the advancement of the gospel. This technology allowed speed and facility of communication across the world unimagined just a decade ago.

Listing of Unreached Peoples

One primary piece of information, which developed over the years, was an integrated listing of the peoples of the world. A first draft was created for GCOWE '95. It was a rough list, compiling every known "least evangelized" ethno-linguistic people within every country of the world. It was only a beginning. It contained all the known peoples (about 4,800) that either were deemed to be most needing a church planting movement in their midst, or had insufficient access to the gospel, or were less than two percent Christian, or were identified as unreached peoples for prayer and mission. The list would be of value if readers actively participated in updating, correcting, and join in the effort to make it an effective tool. As they did, it became of value for country and regional strategy and planning. It became of value for mobilizing the worldwide church for prayer and for mission involvement.

After two years of global dissemination and subsequent improvement, a new list was prepared for GCOWE '97. The process involved networking, which continually revealed the list's deficiencies, as well as the need to refine classifications and terminology.

Johnstone wrote: "This volume is unique for the following reasons:

- It gives the most widely discussed and agreed-upon list of significant unreached peoples ever published.
- It shows the list of 1739 peoples of over 10,000 population among whom there is an inadequate or non-existent church planting movement, and where the Great Commission to make disciples of all peoples has yet to be fulfilled.
- It lists the Joshua Project peoples by country of residence, name, People Cluster and Affinity Bloc. This enables more effective national and global planning for cooperative efforts to plant mature, witnessing churches among them.
- It provides, for the first time, fairly full information on the extent of adoption of

peoples and present or planned Christian ministries among them.
- It provides a mechanism for assessing progress towards the goal of a church for every people by the year 2000 so that we may be accountable to the millions of Christians who are contributing in some way to these goals" (Scribner 1997).

By November 1999, almost 4,000 editorial changes had been made to the list, which now compiled more than 50,000 work-among records from agencies and churches in over 110 countries of the world, recording the church planting efforts among the Joshua Project 2000 peoples. The information on this list enabled the careful monitoring of the procedural goal of a church for every people (See Appendix A).

Prayer Profiles Used by Churches and Cell Groups Worldwide

In 1995, Bethany World Prayer Center, a church in Baton Rouge, Louisiana, accepted the challenge of producing prayer profiles from the Joshua Project list of unreached. These small booklets, containing basic information and prayer requests about specific unreached people, have been used in local churches to pray for these peoples widely throughout the world. Each profile contained a photo, map, and information about the lifestyles, customs, and beliefs of the people. It listed spiritual strongholds and addresses specific prayer needs. The prayer profiles were distributed globally through a global network of cell-group churches.

7. CONSULTATIONS AND THE GREAT COMMISSION

Great Commission efforts were also catalyzed through the process of consultations and conferences. These were gatherings to consult with other Christian leaders who embraced the AD2000 vision. There were augmented city consultations, such as were held in Miami and

Calcutta. There were regional consultations and state consultations within a country, as occurred in North India and Nigeria. Regional consultations also took place by continent, as in Latino America 2000 in 1996. There were also consultations by language, such as Francophone Africa. In addition, there were three Global Consultations on World Evangelization by the Year 2000 and Beyond (GCOWE's) that exponentially multiplied the mobilization impact on Christian leaders.

National Consultations

In most countries where AD2000-type consultations were held, the result was the launching or reinforcement of national initiatives to the year 2000. There ware several basic assumptions related to national consultations based on previous enquiries and evidence. The first assumption was the presence of Christian leaders in every country of the world who were committed to the fulfillment of the Great Commission, who desired fellowship and needed to network with those outside of their country who shared that same vision (Bush 1993:15). The second assumption was the commitment to strengthen existing national movements based on faith goals for the year 2000, and recognition of a need to design viable strategies for all interest groups to work together toward that end. A third basic assumption was the existence in each country of the desire to foster and nurture a viable national initiative where there is none, in whatever way possible—but particularly, through the process of national consultation (Bush 1993:13). In the national consultations key questions frequently including the following (Bush 1993:14):

- What is the Great Commission (Matt. 28:19-20) saying to us?
- What does the Great Commandment (Mark 12:30) say to us?
- How did the gospel get to this country and how did it spread?
- What is the country profile in the following areas: political, economic, social and religious?
- What are the key issues facing the church?
- Who and where are the unreached people and cities?

- What and where are the unreached peoples outside this country to which the church in this country could send missionaries?
- Who and where are the harvesters?
- How do we train those harvesters?

National Christian leaders were encouraged to assume the posture of listening to other national leaders within their countries, and not to arbitrarily set goals for world evangelization on their behalf. This usually involved bringing a variety of leaders together from various theological persuasions, geographical settings, social strata, some of whom had never met due to their differences, for working consultations or short retreats (Bush 1993:15).

Global Consultations

Prayer, reconciliation, partnerships, strategic planning, empowerment, and mobilization were the hallmark outcomes of the 1995 Global Consultation for World Evangelization (Figure 2). Some of these were planned outcomes, but others, such as empowerment and reconciliation, were planned only on the Holy Spirit's agenda. These spiritual initiatives had far reaching effect in mobilizing AD2000 leadership. "I believe that GCOWE is a catalytic atomic bomb" (Verwer 1995:9).

To a number of participants, reconciliation between Christian leaders was life and ministry-changing, unleashing a wave of reconciliation among Christian leaders around the world.

> One of the most powerful forces unleashed at the recent Global Consultation on World Evangelization (GCOWE 95) was the power of reconciliation which broke out like a wildfire, spreading from one meeting to another as various groups forgave each other for the past sins of the people or group they represented. . .
>
> The totally diverse members of the Israeli delegation representing Palestinian and Israeli Arab Christians and Messianic Jews were seen holding hands and hugging each other as they pledged to work together (Wood: 1995:19).

These public expressions of repentance and reconciliation ignited dozens more, as delegates were convicted of generational animosities and individual bitterness which must be repented and cleansed before real partnership could occur. The significance of this was that it was neither predicted nor orchestrated but a natural outcome of the prayer and bonding which occurred between individuals, ethnic groups, mission agencies, denominations, and countries. "Many of the leaders recognized that they could not hope to evangelize the world without first being reconciled with each other" (Australian Presbyterian Life Today 1995).

Avery Willis, Southern Baptist Foreign Mission Board, Vice-President of Overseas Operations, in a speech to the GCOWE '95 delegates said:

> We want to ask forgiveness from you for thinking we could do that kind of job [reaching the world by the year 2000] without you. We recognize that it's going to take the whole body of Christ to reach the people of this world. Business as usual will not get the job done.

The USA delegation prepared their own statement which read in part:

> … we acknowledge and confess our sins of omission and commission, the arrogance expressed in undue national pride, the unjust treatment of minority groups within our own nation, the insensitivity to other nations and cultures, the undue dependence on our own plans and technology, our unteachability, the extravagant appropriation of God's resources for our own use, the conspicuous consumption of global resources, the fragmentation of the Body of Christ, and the imposition upon others of our cultural forms as though they comprised the gospel itself. In sincere humility and in the spirit of reconciliation expressed in 2 Corinthians 5, we ask forgiveness for the negative impact upon others of our sinful attitudes and actions and we express our commitment to the unity of the Body of Christ. Will you forgive us (Cedar 1995)?

The spirit of repentance and reconciliation between Christian leaders flowed into GCOWE '97, the next global conference held in South Africa in June 1997. By this time, it had become clear that reconciliation was a *prerequisite* for world evangelization. One of the most powerful moments was the reconciliation that followed the official written request for

forgiveness presented publicly by a contingent from the host country. A representative from the thirty-five member Salvation Army delegation reported on the scene:

> I am thrilled to share with you the powerful outpouring of God's Holy Spirit during my recent visit to South Africa while representing The Salvation Army at the Global Consultation On World Evangelization (GCOWE '97). Over 4000 delegates from 130 countries gathered for 6 days in Pretoria.
>
> There were times of anguish and calls of repentance. There was recognition of our own sinfulness, pride and prejudices. On the last day as all the consultations gathered for the finale a leading representative from the South African Dutch Reformed Church calmly and somberly read a statement of denominational repentance for the decades of racism tolerated by that church. At the conclusion of the statement--as he received forgiveness from a black pastor--the overwhelming sense of the presence of God was almost unbearable.
>
> One sensed that this was so deep, that centuries of injustice and sin were beginning to be healed, that it was too awe inspiring to watch. The white pastors around me from South Africa were heaving enormous tears of sorrow and pain (Munn 1997).

The reconciliation between Christian leaders that took place at GCOWE ’95 and ’97 impacted participants deeply, paving the way for working together in the national initiatives and resource networks and the Great Commission.

CONCLUSION

The thesis of this paper is that AD2000 served as a Great Commission catalyst by focusing tightly on its purpose which was to motivate and network men and women church leaders by inspiring them with the vision of reaching the unreached by the year 2000 through consultations, prayer efforts and communication materials. The catalytic impact of AD2000 on the Great Commission was viewed by examining AD2000 implementation of the primary elements of the purpose as underlined in the purpose statement above.

Following GCOWE '97 in South Africa, a Christian leader listed the *Unique Contributions of the AD2000 Movement to World Evangelization* which included the following items:

- Has empowered an unprecedented global awareness of and commitment to completion of the Great Commission.
- Has produced an unprecedented, global Third World, Non-Western awareness of, commitment to, and involvement in leadership for fulfillment of the Great Commission.
- Has provided an unprecedented global platform on which mission/church leadership from East/West and North/South have been able to meet for action plans related to fulfillment of the Great Commission.
- Has provided an unprecedented global awareness of the need for national and people-groups specific strategies for evangelism in contrast the traditional ad hoc approaches (Butler 1997).

Another Christian leader wrote: "The AD2000 and Beyond Movement has been raised up by God as the chief force for catalyzing the multiple churches, agencies, ministries and denominations around the world for a concerted effort to complete the task for world evangelization" (Wagner 1993:12).

From the very first formative AD2000 meeting, it was agreed that this would be a catalytic movement seeking to encourage the global Christian community toward the goal of "a church for every people and the gospel for every person" in the decade of the 1990's, and to disband beyond. A disband clause by the year 2001 was incorporated into the AD2000 handbook and the corporate by-laws. In keeping with the agreement AD2000 disbanded. The implications of this commitment with regards to an ongoing vision, movement streams, office, and portions thereof has been a matter constantly questioned.

REFERENCES CITED

American Heritage Dictionary
1997 *The Microsoft Press Computer Dictionary*, 3rd Edition.

Bush, Luis K.
1991 *The 10/40 Window: Getting to the Core of the Core*. San Jose, CA.

1993 *AD2000 and Beyond Handbook*. 3rd Edition, ed. Colorado Springs, CO.: AD2000 and Beyond Movement.

Bush, Luis K. and Beverly Pegues
1999 *The Move of the Holy Spirit in the 10/40 Window*. Jane Rumph, ed. Seattle, WA: YWAM Publishing.

Butler, Phill
1997 Unique Contributions of the AD2000 Movement to World Evangelization E-mail to author. August 17

Douglas, J.D.
1990 *Proclaim Christ Until He Comes*. Ed. Minneapolis, Minnesota: Word wide Publication.

GCOWE '95 Handbook
1995 Colorado Springs, CO.: AD2000 & Beyond Movement.

Grunwald, Henry
1992 "The Year 2000: Is it the end or just the beginning?" *Time Magazine*. March 30. Pp. 73-76.

Hardgrove, David and Mary
1995 "GCOWE '95 - A Ripple Effect." Unpublished manuscript.

Johnstone, Patrick
1992 Letter to author.

1998 *The Church is Bigger than You Think*. Ross-Shire, Great Britain: Christian Focus Publications and WEC.

2000 *Summary Report: Unreached Peoples Network.* Colorado Springs: AD2000 Announce. Sept 7.

Munn, R.J.
1997 "South Africa Victory Report," E-mail to Salvation Army global leaders, July19, 1997.

Naisbitt, John and Aburdene, Patricia
1990 *Megatrends 2000 -- Ten New Directions for the 1990's*. New York: Morrow.

Pegues, Beverly
1997 *Minutes of Praying Through the Window IV: Light the Window*. Colorado Springs. Unpublished manuscript of December 8.

Rogers, Jay
1990 *Review of Religious Revival of the Third Millennium* by John Naisbitt and Patricia Aburdene. Media House International Online. Online. Internet. (Available from http://forerunner.com/forerunner/X0290_Megatrends_authors.html).

Scribner, Dan, ed.
1997 *Global Guide to Unreached Peoples*. Colorado Springs: AD2000 and Beyond Movement.

Tapia, Andreas
1994 "Is a Global Great Awakening Just Around the Corner?" *Christianity Today*, Nov., Pp. 80-85.

Taylor, William D.
1999 *Global Consultation on Evangelical Missiology*, WEF Missions Commission . October 10-16. Iguassu, Paraña, BRAZIL.

Verwer, George
1995 "GCOWE '95." *Mission Frontiers* 17(7-8):9.

Wagner, C. Peter
1993 *Breaking Strongholds in Your City*. Ventura, CA: Regal. Regal Books, Gospel Light, Ventura CA

1996 "Contemporary Dynamics Of -The Holy Spirit In Missions, A Personal Pilgrimage." Paper presented at the Triennial Meeting of EFMA/EMS, held in September 20-23, 1996. Orlando, Florida.

Wang, Thomas
1987 "The Year 2000: Is God trying to tell us Something?" *World Evangelization Magazine,* May-June.

Wood, Rick
1995 "GCOWE '95." *Mission Frontiers* 17(7-8):18.